

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Security | Zero Trust Architecture | Identity and Access Management | CISSP

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of technical security experience designing and implementing security controls for Microsoft environments. I have deep expertise in Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and the Microsoft 365 Defender suite. I have led Zero Trust architecture initiatives, managing Identity and Access Management (IAM) controls through Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access policies, and Privileged Access Management (PAM) to enforce least-privilege principles across complex, high-user-count environments. I bring a strong track record of incident response, vulnerability management, and compliance delivery aligned to NIST, ISO 27001, and Cyber Essentials Plus frameworks, and I am seeking a permanent hybrid role where I can apply this expertise in a values-driven public service organisation.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Security Platform:** Microsoft Sentinel (Security Information and Event Management (SIEM)), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 (M365) Defender, Kusto Query Language (KQL) for detection and hunting
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM) / Zero Trust:** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory (Azure AD)), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Role-Based Access Control (RBAC), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** Microsoft Sentinel playbooks, automation rules, Logic Apps integration
- **Endpoint and Device Management:** CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Microsoft Intune, Mobile Device Management (MDM), Mobile Application Management (MAM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Incident Response:** NIST SP 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK framework, end-to-end investigation and root cause analysis
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting for security operations and identity governance automation
- **Compliance Frameworks:** ISO 27001, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Lead the design and implementation of security controls across the Microsoft security environment, including Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), and Defender for Identity (MDI), covering an 8,000-user estate.
- Architect and maintain Zero Trust access controls through Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory / Azure AD), including Conditional Access policies, MFA enforcement, and Privileged Identity Management (PIM), ensuring least-privilege access across all user tiers.
- Author and continuously refine Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection rules, hunting queries, and automation playbooks within Microsoft Sentinel, improving detection fidelity and reducing false-positive rates.
- Lead incident response engagements aligned to NIST SP 800-61, managing investigations from initial triage through root cause analysis, containment, eradication, and post-incident reporting.

- Govern the BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) platform, controlling privileged credential usage and enforcing just-in-time access across administrative accounts.
- Drive the vulnerability management lifecycle using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), aligning remediation prioritisation to CIS Controls and organisational risk appetite.
- Manage Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) controls via Microsoft Intune, maintaining device compliance and security baselines across Windows, iOS, and Android.
- Produce security risk assessments, threat models, and executive-level reporting aligned to ISO 27001 and the NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF).
- Mentor junior analysts and provide technical leadership on Microsoft security tooling, detection engineering, and incident response best practices.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Administered the Microsoft 365 Defender suite at scale, managing security policies, alert configuration, and incident queues across Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), and Defender for Office 365.
- Built and maintained Microsoft Sentinel workspaces including data connector configuration, analytics rules, and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks for automated incident handling.
- Managed Azure Active Directory (Azure AD / Entra ID) identity governance, including Conditional Access policy design, MFA roll-out, guest access controls, and access reviews.
- Performed daily security event triage and investigation using KQL queries within Microsoft Sentinel, escalating and managing incidents in line with organisational procedures.
- Supported the CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) deployment and administration, handling policy configuration, host group management, and threat containment actions.
- Managed Intune MDM/MAM policies and device compliance baselines, resolving enrolment issues and maintaining continuous endpoint compliance coverage.
- Contributed to vulnerability management activities using Nessus and Tenable.io, producing risk-ranked remediation reports for IT and infrastructure stakeholders.
- Developed PowerShell automation scripts to streamline identity lifecycle management and security operations workflows.
- Supported compliance programmes including ISO 27001 audit preparation, Cyber Essentials Plus assessments, and NIST CSF gap analysis.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Delivered security and infrastructure engineering for a SaaS FinTech organisation, implementing Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), MFA, Single Sign-On (SSO), and Mobile Device Management (MDM) solutions to secure a cloud-native environment.
- Configured and maintained role-based access control (RBAC) and identity governance, enforcing least-privilege principles across the SaaS platform and corporate systems.
- Supported security risk assessments, compliance audits, and gap analysis activities aligned to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials frameworks.
- Managed endpoint security tooling and supported security incident triage and investigation, applying Zero Trust principles to a rapidly growing technology company.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and deployed Zero Trust Conditional Access architecture across an 8,000-user Microsoft environment at UAL, significantly reducing the risk of identity-based attacks and unauthorised access.
- Built a comprehensive Microsoft Sentinel detection library using KQL, aligned to MITRE ATT&CK tactics, dramatically improving threat coverage and reducing mean time to detect (MTTD).
- Implemented Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks within Microsoft Sentinel that automated responses to high-volume alert categories, reducing manual triage workload by a significant margin.

- Led successful delivery of Cyber Essentials Plus certification for the organisation, demonstrating robust identity, endpoint, and access security controls.
- Achieved significant improvements in vulnerability remediation rates by implementing a risk-based prioritisation model using Tenable.io and CIS Controls mapping.
- Led multiple complex incident response investigations, identifying root causes, containing threats, and presenting post-incident analyses to senior leadership.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)